

Boston Sunday Globe

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Land of sun, fun, and . . . viruses?

What to know if Florida drops its vaccine mandate

By Sarah Rahal
GLOBE STAFF

For Massachusetts families wondering about visiting Florida if that state scraps its vaccine requirements, including those for schoolchildren, consider what happened with the latest outbreak of a disease long thought brought to heel by modern medicine.

Starting in January, an outbreak of measles in Texas spread to more than 700 people in three states. It began in a close-knit, low-vaccinated community, and the vast majority who got sick were unvaccinated, including two school-aged children who died.

An airborne virus that can linger for hours, measles is so contagious that nine out of 10 unvaccinated people who cross paths with an infected person will catch it.

But Massachusetts residents have some of the highest vaccination rates in the country — 96 percent of kindergartners in the state are immunized. So while long term the elimination of the vaccine mandates poses major health questions — more immediately for families scheduling their occasional visits to Florida — the risk right now is probably pretty low, according to epidemiologists interviewed by the Globe.

Existing protections don't
VACCINES, Page A14

Feeling that foliage fever

Check out New England's best towns to peep those leaves. **Sunday Travel, N11.**

Massachusetts has a public records law, but that isn't enough to guarantee officials will follow it. **Ideas, K1.**

A disciplinary panel is recommending temporary suspensions for two lawyers who exchanged "racially offensive" emails as they prosecuted an Asian American teen. **Metro, B1.**

Whatever a home's exterior look, buyers focus on modern amenities such as oak floors or pot fillers. **Address, H1.**

Writer Ben Shattuck talks about adapting "The History of Sound" into a film. **Sunday Arts, N1.**



Two perfect

Sunday: Cool but nice. High 65-70. Low 49-54.

Monday: More of the same. High 66-71. Low 58-63.

High tide: 11:43 a.m.

Sunrise: 6:31 Sunset: 6:43

Complete report, C26.

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Suggested retail price
\$6.00



With grief and fear weighing on her like a 'cinder block,' a New Hampshire mother did the unthinkable.



FACEBOOK/GLOBE STAFF PHOTO ILLUSTRATION

The Longs, shown in 2019, "really were a beautiful family," a cousin said. Besides financial problems, they would soon face an overwhelming health issue.

MADBURY, N.H. — The money was gone and so was the couple suspected of stealing it.

It was winter 2016, and police on Nantucket wanted to question Emily Hobson, a 24-year-old restaurant manager from New Hampshire, and her boyfriend.

More than \$11,000 had been drained from the bank account of Nixs, a brew pub on the island where the pair had worked until that prior December. They had been fired amid suspicions about missing cash and alcohol.

Now, they were both on the other end of the world in Thailand, posting photos of their tropical adventure on Facebook. They hung out at fancy hotels in Bangkok. Caught fish in the jungle. They ate authentic dishes of tender rice noodles with fresh basil leaves.

It's unclear if police ever got the answers they were looking for. Hobson, after returning stateside, was ultimately arraigned on multiple check forgery charges in Nantucket District Court that June. But the restaurant closed suddenly later that summer and the case was dismissed.



CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

Derek Fisher, the owner of Wing-Itz, said he was unaware that Emily Long had been accused of theft and trusted her "wholeheartedly."

A decade later, it happened again. Hobson, now 34, married to a different man and taking the name Emily Long, was suspected in August of siphoning off \$660,000 over nearly three years from a restaurant chain here in New Hampshire's Seacoast region.

But this time, there would be no overseas escape.

By then, Long had settled down in her small hometown of Madbury. On the same winding street

where she grew up, she was raising her three young children with her husband, 48-year-old Ryan Long, a child psychologist in the local school district.

The family had been struggling, according to self-described therapy sessions she broadcast on TikTok. Her husband was dying from a newly diagnosed brain cancer, and there was no cure.

Long said she felt stretched thin

MADBURY, Page A15

Congress considers tighter security

Amid threats, concerns about safety clash with fear of being inaccessible

By Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — The threats started flooding in online and over the phone after Representative Seth Moulton went on CNN the day after Charlie Kirk's murder and said President Trump should condemn the violence on the right as well as the left.

The vicious comments targeted not only Moulton, but his family, according to screenshots the Salem Democrat shared on his X account. "Maybe we'll have another shooter in this country somewhere, whether it be in Salem, Mass., or Washington, that will put a [expletive] bullet in his head," one caller said in a voicemail. "Maybe his wife will get shot in the head or maybe one of his kids."

While the volume of threats was unusual, Moulton said, their violent nature was not.

"It's certainly not the first time that I've gotten death threats," he told the Globe, "but it's pretty horrific in the wake of what happened."

It's also part of being in Congress in a bitterly divided nation where the assassination of Kirk, a young conservative activist, was just the latest instance of political violence. In the aftermath, democracy experts said, elected officials could be pushed deeper into a secure bubble, making it harder for average Americans to interact with them.

SECURITY, Page A10

For the right, Kirk furor tests price of speech

Some conservatives on edge over payback push

By Jeremy W. Peters
NEW YORK TIMES

The anguished calls for retribution have intensified in the time since Charlie Kirk's assassination, with prominent conservatives waging a campaign to encourage public shaming, firings, and the threat of prosecution for those who speak ill of him.

Yet a few influential supporters of Kirk are now warning that attacks from the right on political expression could tarnish the legacy of the combative right-wing activist, who was seen as a champion of free speech by his legions of followers.

Tucker Carlson, the conservative writer and podcaster, told listeners last week that Kirk never would have wanted his death to be used as a pretext for a crackdown on speech.

"You hope that a year from now, the turmoil we're seeing in the aftermath of his murder won't be leveraged to bring hate speech laws to this country," said Carlson, who himself was dropped from Fox News in 2023 after revelations that he had made a comment implying

SPEECH, Page A10

Kirk memorial today

The service will take place in Arizona and will be broadcast by some news outlets. More details about the event, **A10.**

In Randolph, renters are losing their lease on suburban destination

Evictions soar in town popular among people of color

RANDOLPH

Population: 35,000

Average rent: \$2,600 a month

Eviction filings per 1,000 renter households Jan.-June 2025:



Randolph
41.5



State
16.9

By Mara Kardas-Nelson

GLOBE STAFF

CANTON — Encouraged by the housing court judge to work out a settlement rather than risk a judgment, the tenant and the landlord's attorney stepped out into the hallway, where the conversation soon turned heated.

"Stop violating our rights. We are tenants," the woman, who was facing eviction, pleaded. "I've begged them, we have kids and there's an elderly woman living with us."

This was just one of many

tense moments on a recent Tuesday at the Metro South Housing Court, a battleground of increasing desperation for a seemingly unexpected population: renters in Randolph, a Boston suburb of roughly 35,000 that has the highest eviction rate of any community in Massachusetts, more than double the statewide average.

Long a haven for residents pushed out of Boston's increasingly competitive housing market, Randolph has one of the

RANDOLPH, Page A14



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

Cheryl Lloyd (center) lives away from her children, Wynter and Brian, because she can't afford a large enough place.